GROUP PROJECT

Assessment Standard of Group Projects

Assessment considers four areas: workload, reasoning quality, presentation performance, and report quality. Make the work behind your project visible, explain how your approach developed, and support your conclusions with evidence.

A. Workload

- **Dataset sourcing and accessibility:** where the data came from, how it was accessed, and any collection or access challenges.
- **Data cleaning and preparation:** the additional work needed to make the data usable, such as handling missing values, correcting inconsistencies, or preparing features.
- **Model development and iteration:** the approaches explored, experiments conducted, and changes made as the project progressed.

B. Reasoning Quality

- **Comparison with baseline methods:** how much your approach improves upon simple or "vanilla" methods, and what the comparison reveals.
- **Development of the approach:** why changes were made, what was learned from each iteration, and whether the evidence supports the claimed improvement.
- **Improvement of the overall pipeline:** how decisions across data preparation, modelling, and evaluation contributed to the final results.

The reasoning process matters alongside the final outcome. Explain what worked and what did not, and relate your conclusions to the evidence.

C. Presentation Performance

- **Slides:** clear structure, readable visuals, and effective communication of the key ideas and results.
- **Storytelling:** connect the problem to the audience, explain why it matters, show how the method developed and improved, and bring the story to a coherent conclusion.
- **Technical depth:** explain the important methods, decisions, and evidence with sufficient detail to demonstrate understanding.

D. Report Quality

Provide a comprehensive account of the project, balancing storytelling with technical depth. Connect the problem, dataset, methods, experiments, results, and conclusions so that the reader can follow both the overall story and the reasoning behind it.

Questions & Answers

Questions submitted by the student **“Brown Destiny”**.

Scope of the Dataset

Q. Should our project focus specifically on a Hong Kong dataset, or are we free to use datasets from any region as long as they are relevant?

A. Feel free to use any dataset that your group is most interested in. **Bonus tip:** relating the dataset or project idea to something familiar to most people often helps you tell a better story.

Assessment Criteria

Q. Could you provide more details on the criteria used to evaluate the project, particularly what distinguishes a high-quality proposal and final submission?

A. We assess the workload involved in sourcing and accessing the dataset, cleaning and preparing the data, and iterating on models. We also assess the quality of the reasoning process and results: improvement over baseline methods, the reasoning behind refinements, and how the overall data science pipeline is improved to achieve the final outcome. This note sets out the assessment standard, including presentation performance and report quality.

Model Evaluation and Reflection

Q. For the conclusion and reflection section, would it be beneficial to compare our model’s predictions with actual observed data and discuss differences, limitations, and possible reasons for the results? Is it acceptable if the observed data will only become available later?

A. Yes. We strongly encourage you to gather real, new data to test your model and discuss what the comparison reveals. This can strengthen your intuition and clarify the project’s practical impact. We recognise the availability constraints and additional workload involved. It is fine if you do not have real or new data, provided that the available data supports the story and conclusions you present.